requirements[10].

KHARIF & RABI

There are certain special terms used to understand the cropping seasons of India. The agricultural crop year in India is from *July to June.* The Indian cropping season is classified into two main seasons- (i) Kharif and (ii) Rabi based on the monsoon. The kharif cropping season is from *July to October* during the South-West/Summer Monsoon and the Rabi cropping season is from *October to March* (Nort/East/Returning/Winter Monsoon). The crops grown between March and June are summer crops, known as the *jayads*.

Pakistan and Bangladesh are two other countries that are using the term 'kharif' and 'rabi' to describe about their cropping patterns. The terms 'kharif' and 'rabi' originate from Arabic language where Kharif means *autumn* and Rabi means *spring.*

The kharif crops include rice, maize, sorghum, pearl millet/bajra, finger millet/ragi (cereals), arhar (pulses), soyabean, groundnut (oilseeds), cotton etc. The rabi crops include wheat, barley, oats (cereals), chickpea/gram (pulses), linseed, mustard (oilseeds) etc.

FOOD PHILOSOPHY OF INDIA

Indian food philosophy[11] is generally seen divided into three phases with their own objectives and challenges:

The First Phase

This phase continued for the first three decades after the independence. The main aim and the struggle of this phase was producing as much foodgrains as required by the Indian population i.e—achieving ***physical access*** to food.

The idea of Green Revolution at the end of this phase at least gave India the confidence of realising the objective. At the end of 1980s, India was a self-sufficient country regarding food.